Sourceline — Rollout Plan

27 October 2026

This plan takes Sourceline from a working platform that nobody uses yet to fifteen business units running their procurement on it. It is written to be executed, so every phase has an exit test somebody can actually perform.

The platform is further along than the rollout. All fifteen units are deployed, reachable over HTTPS on their own addresses, and the complete procurement cycle has been run end to end against the live system. What is missing is not software.

1. Where things stand

	Status
Fifteen units deployed, own hostnames, valid certificates	Done
Unit identified by hostname; sessions cannot cross units	Done and verified
Full procurement cycle, 50 steps, against live production	Passed
Units populated with real data	Only Dokuma, and only with test data
Administrator accounts able to receive email	No — addresses are not real
Two-factor sign-in	Switched off
Database backups	Unconfirmed; the tier suggests none
A fix for a broken dashboard	Committed, not deployed

Four of those seven are blockers. None of them is a code change.

2. Principles

One unit all the way before any unit partially. Fifteen half-configured units teach nothing and generate fifteen times the confusion. Dokuma goes first, end to end, with real people.

A unit is live only when a real purchase completes in it. Not when accounts exist. The exit test for every phase is a genuine requisition reaching payment.

Stop the wave if the pilot teaches something. The point of a pilot is to change the plan. Build in the time to act on it.

Nothing irreversible without a backup. The migration that clears transactions, and the first real purchase, both assume the data can be recovered. Until that is confirmed, neither should happen.

3. Phase 0 — Clear the blockers

Nothing else starts until these are done. Estimated: three to five working days, most of it waiting on others.

#	Task	Owner	Done when
0.1	Confirm the Atlas tier and whether automated backups exist	Technical	Written confirmation of backup frequency and retention
0.2	If there are none, move production to a tier that has them	Technical	A restore has been tested, not just enabled
0.3	Move development and staging to a separate cluster	Technical	Production's collection budget is no longer shared
0.4	Deploy the pending dashboard fix	Technical	Department heads outside Procurement can load their dashboard
0.5	Decide the administrator email addresses for all fifteen units	Business	A named, working mailbox per unit
0.6	Replace the placeholder addresses and set real passwords	Technical	Each administrator can receive a password reset
0.7	Switch two-factor sign-in back on	Technical	A real emailed code is required to sign in
0.8	Correct CLIENT_URL so email links resolve	Technical	A notification email links to a working address

Exit test. An administrator in any unit signs out, requests a password reset, receives the email, resets, signs back in with a real emailed verification code.

Until 0.7 is done the system is not secure: anyone who knows an email address can sign in as that person, finance included. That is acceptable for testing and not for live purchasing.

4. Phase 1 — Pilot: Dokuma

One unit, real people, real purchases, for two to three weeks.

Prepare

#	Task	Owner
1.1	Clear the test data from Dokuma	Technical
1.2	Create Dokuma's real sites and departments	Dokuma admin
1.3	Create real users with real email addresses, one per role	Dokuma admin
1.4	Onboard ten to fifteen real suppliers, with due diligence completed	Procurement
1.5	Load the item catalogue and opening stock balances	Stores
1.6	Set department budgets for the current year	Finance

#	Task	Owner
1.7	Confirm the approval threshold and chain match Dokuma's actual delegation of authority	Finance, COO
1.8	Train each role — one session, by role, using their own data	Business

Item 1.7 is the one most often skipped and most expensive to discover later. The system enforces USD 5,000 and a four-stage chain because that is what it was built with; if Dokuma's real authority limits differ, the system will enforce the wrong rule faithfully.

Run

Dokuma processes its real procurement through Sourceline for two to three weeks, with the old process kept as a fallback but not used in parallel. Running both doubles the work and guarantees neither is trusted.

Exit tests

1. At least ten real requisitions have reached payment.
2. At least one purchase above the COO threshold has gone through all four approvals.
3. At least one invoice has been correctly refused for goods not receipted.
4. Stores has received goods and the stock figures match a physical count.
5. Finance confirms the budget figures agree with their own records.
6. No unresolved issue rated urgent.

Decide

Hold a review. Three outcomes are legitimate: proceed, proceed after fixes, or stop. Write down which and why.

5. Phase 2 — First wave: three units

Khayah Cement, Titan and Kurima Centre. Chosen because they differ from each other and from Dokuma — a cement producer, a services business and a retailer — so the second wave is informed by variety rather than repetition.

Run the per-unit checklist in section 7, three units in parallel, two weeks.

Exit test. Each unit has completed five real purchases to payment, and the separation checks in section 8 pass across all four live units.

6. Phase 3 and 4 — The remainder

Phase 3: the other eight Zimbabwean units — Fossil, Mandfar, Masimba, Persimmon, ProPlastics, Rhopower, The Grain Hub, Trends. Two units a week, using the checklist.

Phase 4: the three South African units — Enviro Plastic, Mangethe, Thando Kinetics. These need work Phases 1 to 3 do not: South African supplier compliance (B-BBEE, CIDB, SARS), and ZAR. Currency is not yet carried on orders, invoices or payments, so treat Phase 4 as dependent on that being built, not as another wave.

Fossil is in Phase 3 rather than first despite being the original business, because it is the unit most likely to carry historical data and expectations, and is better done once the process is proven.

7. The per-unit checklist

Repeatable for every unit after the pilot.

#	Step	Owner
1	Confirm the unit's hostname resolves and serves over HTTPS	Technical
2	Build the unit's indexes	Technical
3	Set a real administrator address and password	Technical
4	Create sites and departments	Unit admin
5	Create users, one per role, real addresses	Unit admin
6	Confirm the approval chain and threshold against the unit's delegation of authority	Unit finance
7	Onboard suppliers with due diligence completed and spend authorisation	Unit procurement
8	Load the catalogue and opening stock	Unit stores
9	Set department budgets	Unit finance
10	Train each role	Business
11	Run one complete purchase, start to payment, as a rehearsal	Unit
12	Confirm the unit sees no other unit's data	Technical

A unit is live when step 11 passes with real people and real money.

8. Separation checks, each time a unit goes live

These run against every pair of live units, and they are not optional. A leak discovered after four units are live is four times the problem.

- A session opened in one unit is refused by another.
- A supplier added in one does not appear in the other.
- Document numbers restart per unit, and that is expected rather than a collision.
- A user of one unit cannot sign in at another's address.

9. Training

One session per role rather than one session per unit. The end user's session is fifteen minutes; the procurement officer's is an hour.

Audience	Covers
End users	Raise a requisition, track it, read notifications
Department heads	Approve requisitions and orders, select a winning quotation with justification
Procurement	Sourcing, RFQs, award, purchase orders, supplier due diligence
Finance	Order approval, the three-way match, invoices, payments, budgets
Stores	Stock checks, goods receipt, acceptance and rejection, transfers
COO	Authorising above the threshold, and what the figures mean
Suppliers	Registering, completing due diligence, quoting, acknowledging, invoicing

Supplier training is the one usually forgotten. Suppliers who cannot quote will be chased by telephone and the competitive-quotation control quietly lapses.

10. Cutover and fallback

Cutover is per unit, not group-wide. A unit switches when its rehearsal passes.

In-flight work stays where it started. Purchases already under way in the old process finish there. Sourceline starts with new requisitions only. Migrating part-finished purchases is more error-prone than letting them drain.

Fallback is the old process, unchanged, for that unit alone. It stays available for the first month after a unit goes live. The trigger for using it is a defect that stops purchasing and has no workaround within a day.

11. Risks

Risk	Consequence	What reduces it
No database backup when the first real purchase is recorded	Unrecoverable loss of financial records	Phase 0.1 and 0.2, before anything else
Approval thresholds do not match real delegated authority	The system enforces the wrong rule, faithfully, on real money	Step 6 of the per-unit checklist
Suppliers cannot or will not use the portal	Quotations collected by telephone; the competitive control lapses	Supplier training, and monitoring quote counts per RFQ
Units go live in parallel before the pilot is reviewed	The same defect is repeated fifteen times	Phase gates, and the authority to stop
Administrators keep placeholder addresses	No password resets, no approval notifications	Phase 0.5 and 0.6
The shared cluster reaches its ceiling	Writes fail in every unit, production included	Phase 0.3

12. Indicative timeline

Assumes blockers are cleared promptly and the pilot does not force a change of plan.

Phase	Duration	Cumulative
0 — Clear blockers	1 week	Week 1
1 — Dokuma pilot	3 weeks	Week 4
Review and fixes	1 week	Week 5
2 — First wave, three units	2 weeks	Week 7
3 — Eight Zimbabwean units	4 weeks	Week 11
4 — South African units	Depends on currency support	—

Twelve units live in about eleven weeks. Phase 4 is deliberately unscheduled: it depends on work that has not been built, and putting a date on it would be a guess presented as a plan.